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THIS WEEK AT A GLANCE

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LEAD
STORY

Azerbaijan Switches On Its First Crowdfunding Regime

Decree of 24 July 2026 — Law No. 450-VIIQ

The defining instrument of the week is the Presidential Decree of **24 July 2026** applying the Law "**On Crowdfunding**" (**Kraudfandinq haqqında**), **No. 450-VIIQ of 14 July 2026** — the Republic's first dedicated statutory framework for investment- and lending-based crowdfunding platforms. The decree is the trigger that converts an adopted statute into a live regulatory project, and it hands the substantive rulemaking to the **Central Bank of the Republic of Azerbaijan**.

Under the decree, the President reserves to himself the powers arising under **Articles 3.2 and 18.8** of the Law, rather than delegating them to an executive authority. The **Cabinet of Ministers** is given **four months** to bring presidential acts into conformity with the Law and resolve other implementation questions, and **three months** to determine the offshore zones to which the Law's restrictions will attach.

The **Central Bank** has **six months** to adopt the regulatory acts that will decide whether the market is workable: operator capital requirements and minimum aggregate capital thresholds; technical standards for crowdfunding platforms; per-project and per-platform investment ceilings for individual investors; the funding thresholds above which professional-investor participation becomes mandatory; investor complaint procedures; and reporting forms and filing procedure.

Why this matters for the firm: the six-month Central Bank window is the consultation period in practice. Fintech, capital-markets and banking clients contemplating a platform launch should be positioning now — the capital and investment-cap parameters, once fixed, will determine the viability of retail-facing models. Expect draft CBAR acts to circulate well before the January 2027 outer limit.

DECREE

24 July 2026

Application of the Law "On Crowdfunding" No. 450-VIIQ of 14 July 2026

Brings the new crowdfunding statute into operation. Powers under Arts. 3.2 and 18.8 retained by the President. Cabinet: four months to align presidential acts; three months to designate offshore zones. Central Bank: six months to issue six categories of implementing regulation (see lead story).

DECREE

24 July 2026

Implementation of Law No. 469-VIIQD of 14 July 2026 amending the Law "On Execution"

Amends Presidential Decree **No. 672 of 5 March 2002** on the application of the Law "On Execution": the reference to the second sentence of Article 27.4 is deleted from paragraph 2.1, and paragraph 2.2-1 is repealed in full. Part one of Presidential Decree **No. 406 of 5 June 2025** — which had implemented Law No. 196-VIIQD of 16 May 2025 on civil procedure and execution — is also repealed.

DECREE

24 July 2026

Application of Law No. 464-VIIQD of 14 July 2026 amending the Laws "On Medical Insurance" and "On the Rights of Persons with Disabilities"

A structural reorganisation of mandatory medical insurance. Implementing authority passes from the State Agency on Mandatory Health Insurance to the **Ministry of Labour and Social Protection of the Population**, with a new **State Medical Insurance and Expertise Agency** established within the Ministry. A "Mandatory Medical Insurance" subsystem is to be formed within the Ministry's centralised electronic information system by **1 January 2027**. The Cabinet has three months to submit draft rules on the classification and investment of MMI fund reserves. Conforming amendments are made to Decrees No. 502/2019 and No. 634/2019.

DECREE

24 July 2026

Amendment to the Statute of the Ministry of Economy

Amends the "Statute of the Ministry of Economy of the Republic of Azerbaijan" approved by Presidential Decree No. 911 of 30 December 2019. Institutional-competence change; the consolidated text should be checked on e-qanun.az before relying on any allocation of ministerial functions.

DECREE

23 July 2026

Application of Law No. 444-VIIQD of 13 July 2026 amending the Law "On Psychiatric Care"

Puts the psychiatric care amendments into effect and amends Presidential Decree **No. 574 of 3 September 2001** on the application of the Law "On Psychiatric Care". Relevant to health-sector regulatory work and to capacity, guardianship and involuntary-treatment questions.

DECREE

23 July 2026

Application of Law No. 432-VIIQD of 30 June 2026 amending the Housing Code and the legislation on refugees and internally displaced persons

Implements the housing and IDP-status amendment package adopted at the close of the spring session. Read together with the Presidential Order of the same date amending the State Programme on refugees and IDPs (Section 2), this is the second of two instruments touching resettlement entitlements this week.

ORDER

23 July 2026

Amendment to the State Programme on refugees and internally displaced persons

Amends Presidential Order No. 298 of 1 July 2004 approving the "State Programme on improving the living conditions and increasing the employment of refugees and internally displaced persons". The only policy-instrument order of the week; the remainder are appointments and honours.

ORDER

24 July 2026

R.F. Aslanov appointed Ambassador Extraordinary and Plenipotentiary to the Republic of Türkiye

Head-of-mission appointment to Ankara.

ORDER

24 July 2026

R.F. Aslanov recalled from his posts in Rome

Recall from the offices of Ambassador to the Italian Republic (concurrently accredited to Malta and San Marino) and Permanent Representative to the FAO, the World Food Programme and IFAD.

ORDER

24 July 2026

R.E. Məmmədov appointed Ambassador Extraordinary and Plenipotentiary to the Republic of Uzbekistan

Head-of-mission appointment to Tashkent.

ORDER

24 July 2026

R.E. Məmmədov recalled from the post of Ambassador to the Republic of Türkiye

Paired with the Aslanov appointment above — a direct succession at the Ankara mission, executed in a single four-order sequence on 24 July.

ORDER

25 July 2026

M.İ. Yevdayev decorated with the Order "For Service to the Motherland", 1st degree

State honour ("Vətənə xidmətə görə" ordeni).

Four Cabinet decisions fall within the reporting period, all adopted on **24 July 2026**.

DECISION

No. 236

24 July 2026

Model structure and staff units of enterprises providing restoration, construction and management services in the liberated territories

The most commercially significant Cabinet instrument of the week. Approves a standard organisational template for the entities delivering reconstruction and estate-management services in the territories — a further step in institutionalising the governance layer above the reconstruction programme. Relevant to contractors, sub-contractors and anyone negotiating with these entities.

DECISION

No. 237

24 July 2026

Amendment to the unified budget classification of the Republic of Azerbaijan

Amends Cabinet Decision No. 440 of 11 October 2018 approving the unified budget classification. Technical, but consequential for public-sector reporting lines and for clients whose funding flows through classified budget headings.

DECISION

No. 235

24 July 2026

Amendments in connection with the implementation of Law No. 364-VIIQD of 27 February 2026 amending the Law "On Cinematography"

Secondary legislation catching up with the February cinematography amendments. Of interest to media, production and IP practices, and to any client relying on film-sector incentives.

DECISION

No. 234

24 July 2026

Amendment concerning the bachelor's degree levels of higher education institutions

Adjustment to the bachelor's-level framework of higher education institutions. Relevant to education-sector clients and to professional-qualification recognition questions.

Immediately outside this window: Cabinet Decisions **No. 231** and **No. 230** (22 July — concessional lending by the Azerbaijan Business Development Fund; fixed-term supplements to the salaries of medical personnel in Baku health services) and **No. 222** (20 July — rules on

services in social rehabilitation institutions) fall just before the reporting period and are noted here for continuity.

No parliamentary activity in the reporting period. The Milli Majlis is in summer recess. All four monitored registers were checked and none records an entry between 23 and 27 July 2026: the most recent laws are dated **14 July 2026**, the most recent parliamentary decree **26 May 2026** (No. 411-VIIQR), the most recent bills tabled **14 July 2026**, and the most recent report **26 May 2026**. The autumn session is expected to resume the legislative programme adopted under Decree No. 342-VIIQR.

Carried forward — the 7–14 July legislative package. Although outside this issue's window, the statutes enacted in the closing fortnight of the spring session are the direct object of the decrees reported above and are set out here for reference: **450-VIIQ** (On Crowdfunding), **463-VIIQD** (compulsory insurance against loss of professional capacity from industrial accidents and occupational diseases), **464-VIIQD** (medical insurance / rights of persons with disabilities), **469-VIIQD** (On Execution), **472-VIIQD** (consequential amendments following the Law on Gas Supply), **447-VIIQD** (public procurement), **444-VIIQD** (psychiatric care), **443-VIIQ** (Azerbaijan–Sudan diplomatic passport visa waiver), **441-VIIQD** (customs tariff), **439-VIIQD** (road traffic), **434-VIIQD** (general education) and **433-VIIQD** (Milli Majlis internal rules). Nineteen bills were tabled on 14 July, including amendments to the Constitutional Law on Normative Legal Acts, the Civil, Criminal, Tax, Labour, Land, Migration and Administrative Offences Codes, and new draft laws on seed production and on fisheries.

No decisions handed down in the reporting period. The portal was retrieved successfully this week (it was unavailable when Issue No. 1 was compiled). The most recent decision on the register is dated **25 June 2026**, interpreting Articles 3.1 and 3.1.2 of the Law on Combating the Legalisation of Criminally Obtained Property and the Financing of Terrorism. Also of note from the June term, and not previously reported in this digest: decisions of **24 June** (Art. 420 of the Criminal Procedure Code, judicial independence), **23 June** (the A. Şükürova complaint — conformity of Art. 14.2 of the Housing Code with Arts. 29(III) and 71(I, II) of the Constitution), **22 June** (Arts. 122.2.3 and 449.3 CPC) and **16 June** (Arts. 329.1, 337.1 and 739.2 of the Civil Code — equality and property rights).

⚠ **Data Not Extractable.** The e-Qanun portal continues to render its listings dynamically via JavaScript and exposes no static index to automated review; the retrieved page contained no act data. All acts reported in this issue were sourced from the issuing institutions' own registers (president.az, nk.gov.az). Readers should consult e-qanun.az directly for the consolidated, in-force texts before advising on any item above.

DATE	DIRECTION	COUNTERPARTY	OFFICE	OCCASION
26 Jul	OUTBOUND	Mohamed Muizzu	President of the Republic of Maldives	Independence Day greeting
23 Jul	OUTBOUND	Abdel Fattah El-Sisi	President of the Arab Republic of Egypt	National Day greeting

Context: correspondence volume is markedly lower than in Issue No. 1, consistent with the summer period. The substantive diplomatic activity of the month sits just outside this window — the Azerbaijan–Germany *Joint Declaration on a Strategic Agenda for the Bilateral*

Partnership and the accompanying press statements with Federal Chancellor Friedrich Merz, both dated **21 July 2026**. Teams advising on German-market trade, energy and investment should review that declaration.

COMPLIANCE DIARY Deadlines Created This Week

Derived from the decrees of 23–24 July 2026

INDICATIVE DUE DATE	RESPONSIBLE BODY	OBLIGATION	SOURCE INSTRUMENT
~24 Oct 2026 (3 months)	Cabinet of Ministers	Determine the offshore zones to which the Crowdfunding Law's restrictions attach	Decree of 24 Jul 2026 (Law 450-VIIQ)
~24 Oct 2026 (3 months)	Cabinet of Ministers	Submit to the President draft rules on the classification and investment of mandatory medical insurance fund reserves	Decree of 24 Jul 2026 (Law 464-VIIQD)
~24 Nov 2026 (4 months)	Cabinet of Ministers	Submit proposals bringing presidential acts into conformity with the Crowdfunding Law	Decree of 24 Jul 2026 (Law 450-VIIQ)
1 Jan 2027 (fixed date)	Ministry of Labour & Social Protection	Complete formation of the "Mandatory Medical Insurance" subsystem within the centralised electronic information system	Decree of 24 Jul 2026 (Law 464-VIIQD)
~24 Jan 2027 (6 months)	Central Bank (CBAR)	Adopt regulatory acts on operator capital and minimum aggregate capital; platform technical standards; retail investment ceilings per project and per platform; professional-investor participation thresholds; investor complaint procedure; reporting forms and filing procedure	Decree of 24 Jul 2026 (Law 450-VIIQ)

Due dates are computed from the date of the relevant decree and are **indicative**. The operative instruments express these obligations as periods ("within three months", "within six months"); the precise running of time should be confirmed against the published texts before any date is diarised for a client.

REGULATORY SPOTLIGHT — KEY THEMES, WEEK 31 / 2026

1. A New Market Opens — Crowdfunding

Law 450-VIIQ is the first Azerbaijani statute to regulate crowdfunding as a distinct activity, and the 24 July decree starts the clock on the Central Bank's rulemaking. Until the CBAR acts land, the perimeter — who counts as an operator, what capital they must hold, what a retail investor may commit — is undefined. Corporate, banking and fintech teams should be scoping platform structures now and treating the next two quarters as the window in which the commercial parameters of this market are settled.

3. Enforcement Framework Pruned

The decree implementing Law 469-VIIQD strips provisions from Decree No. 672/2002 and repeals part of Decree No. 406/2025 — the implementing scaffolding around the Law "On Execution" is being simplified rather than extended. Litigation and debt-recovery practitioners should re-check any enforcement strategy that relied on the deleted paragraph 2.2-1 or on the second sentence of Article 27.4, and should not assume the 2025 implementing provisions still stand.

2. Health Insurance Administration Restructured

The 24 July decree on Law 464-VIIQD moves mandatory medical insurance out of the standalone State Agency and into the Ministry of Labour and Social Protection, creating a State Medical Insurance and Expertise Agency inside the Ministry. This is a change of counterparty as much as of competence: employers, insurers and providers should identify every contract, filing and correspondence channel currently addressed to the Agency. The 1 January 2027 systems deadline is the practical migration date.

4. Liberated Territories — From Programme to Institution

Cabinet Decision No. 236 approves model structures and staff units for the enterprises delivering restoration, construction and management services in the liberated territories, while the Presidential Order of 23 July amends the 2004 State Programme on refugees and IDPs and the decree of the same date implements the Housing Code / IDP-status amendments. Three instruments in three days: the reconstruction effort is acquiring a standing administrative architecture, and the counterparties to reconstruction contracts are being formalised.

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